

XUQIAN MA

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Education

University of California, Berkeley

PhD in Health Policy (Health Economics)

Dissertation: "*Economic Rationality, Aging, and Health Behaviors*"

Berkeley, CA

May 2027 (expected)

Cornell University

MS in Economics (International and Development Economics)

Thesis: "*Particulate Matter, Micronutrient Supplement, and Early Childhood Development*"

Ithaca, NY

May 2022

University of Minnesota Twin Cities

BS in Economics (Quantitative Economics and Econometrics)

Minneapolis, MN

May 2020

References

William H. Dow (Chair), Shachar Kariv, Edward Miguel

Research Interests

Health economics, development economics, behavioral and experimental economics

Job Market Paper

"Economic Rationality and Preventive Health Behaviors"

Publications and Papers Under Review

- "Impacts of Contemporaneous Air Pollution Exposure on Cognitive Performance in Kenya," with Michelle N. Layvant, Edward Miguel, Eric Ochieng, Ajay Pillarisetti, and Michael W. Walker. *Journal of Health Economics* 109: 103166 (2026). [Journal](#) | [NBER](#) | [VoxDevLit](#)
- "Mitigating Cognitive Deficits from Prenatal Air Pollution: Experimental Evidence from a Nutrition Intervention," with Yuhang Pan, Lingling Hou, and Renfu Luo. Revise and resubmit, *Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists*.

Working Papers and Work in Progress

- "The Long-Term Consequences of the Vietnam War on Older Adults' Cognition and Mental Health," with William H. Dow and Yasuhiko Saito (in preparation for submission).
- "Economic Preferences and Health Behaviors," with Edward Miguel (in progress).
- "Predicting Personal Air Pollution Exposure in Kenya using Machine Learning," with Edward Miguel (in progress).

Presentations

ESE-RGHI-GHE Workshop on Health Economics in LMICs	2026
Population Association of America Annual Meeting (Best Poster Award)	2025
Psychology and Economics of Poverty Convening	2024
Pacific Conference for Development Economics	2024
4th Asian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics	2023
Harvard Spatial Data Lab Monthly Webinars on Spatiotemporal Innovation	2023

Teaching

PH226C: Economics of Population Health Graduate Student Instructor, Berkeley Public Health	Spring 2026
PH226CW: Economics of Population Health (Online) Graduate Student Instructor, Berkeley Public Health	Spring 2025, 2026
PH226FW: Cost-Effectiveness Analysis (Online) Graduate Student Instructor, Berkeley Public Health	Spring 2025, 2026

Other Research Experience

Center for Effective Global Action <i>Research Assistant to Edward Miguel</i> Project: Kenya Life Panel Survey	Berkeley, CA May 2023 - present
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Funded Fellowships and Awards

Preparing Future Faculty UDL Working Group Grant	Summer 2025
Summer Research Fellowship	Summer 2023, 2024, 2025
Best Poster Award - Population Association of America Annual Meeting	Spring 2025
Shortell/Schaeffer Fellowship	Fall 2024 - Spring 2025
Berkeley Fellowship for Graduate Study	Fall 2022 - Spring 2024
Berkeley Health Policy Department Conference Travel Grant	Fall 2023, Spring 2025
Berkeley Graduate Division Conference Travel Grant	Fall 2023